

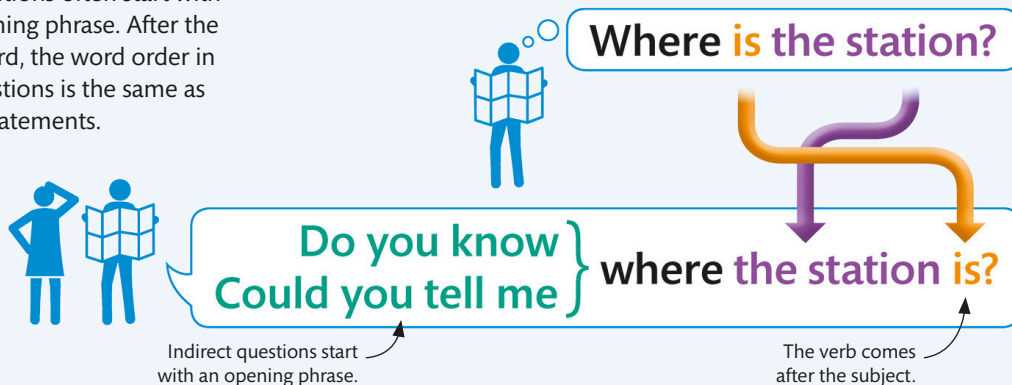
75 Polite questions

Indirect questions are more polite than direct questions. In spoken English, you might use them to ask people who you don't know very well about practical issues.

-  **New language** Indirect questions
-  **Vocabulary** Practical issues
-  **New skill** Asking polite questions

75.1 KEY LANGUAGE INDIRECT QUESTIONS

Indirect questions often start with a polite opening phrase. After the question word, the word order in indirect questions is the same as in positive statements.



75.2 FURTHER EXAMPLES INDIRECT QUESTIONS

Do you know how much **the tickets will cost**?

Could you tell me why **you were** late?

Like reported questions, indirect questions leave out the auxiliary verb "do."

Could you tell me what time **the stores close**?

75.3 HOW TO FORM INDIRECT QUESTIONS

OPENING PHRASE

QUESTION WORD

SUBJECT

VERB

Do you know

where

the station

is?

Could you tell me

Start with a polite opening phrase.

The verb doesn't change to the past tense for indirect questions.